

Security Intelligence Dashboard

User guide for reading the dashboard and maintaining your own copy of it.

1. How to read and use the dashboard

The dashboard is organised into clear sections so you can quickly see where the highest risk is, what is driving it, and which incidents to follow up.

1.1 Top bar — what you are looking at

At the very top you will find the dashboard title and a short summary line: the date the report was generated, the total number of incidents shown, the time window covered (for example **last 3 days**) and how many sources are being monitored. This line is your quick orientation each time you open the file.

1.2 Filter bar — narrowing the view

- **Country** — show only incidents in one of the monitored countries.
- **Severity** — show only Critical, High or Medium incidents.
- **Type** — narrow by threat type (Armed Conflict, Terrorism, Drone Attack, etc.).
- **Status** — show only items you have marked as New, Verified, Escalated, etc.
- **Min. confidence** — hide low-confidence items if you want only the strongest signals.
- **Origin** — show only traditional news, only social media signals, or both.
- **From date** — start the view from a specific day.

Active filters appear as small grey chips next to the bar. Click **■ Clear** to reset everything.

1.3 Severity levels

- **● Critical (red)** — active threat, requires immediate attention. Examples: large-scale armed clashes, mass-casualty events, drone strikes on populated areas.
- **▲ High (orange)** — serious development, monitor closely and review within 24 hours.
- **■ Medium (yellow)** — relevant context. Keep on file but no immediate action required.

1.4 Country intelligence panel

On the right side you will see the monitored countries. Each row shows the flag, total incidents, severity counts and a small 14-day trend line. The arrow on the right indicates rising, falling or stable activity.

Click any country to open its detail card. The card has several tabs:

- **Overview** — summary, key regions affected, dominant threat types.

- **Incidents** — full list of recent incidents in that country.
- **Social** — X (Twitter) accounts being monitored, grouped by type (Press, Government, NGO, Analyst, Conflict Monitor).
- **Sources** — quick links to the news outlets used.
- **Actions** — recommended operational steps based on the threats observed.

1.5 Incident feed

The main column shows every incident as an individual card with country, type, severity badge, source, date, description, region and a confidence bar. Click anywhere on the card (outside the buttons) to open a full detail window with all available information and a direct link to the original article.

Use the small buttons on each card to add the incident to your briefing or mark it as **Verified**, **Escalated** or **Archived**. These markers are stored in your browser.

1.6 Other views

- **Timeline** — the default card feed.
- **Table** — sortable spreadsheet-style view of every incident, useful when scanning many items quickly.
- **Analytics** — summary charts: threat type, severity by country, incidents over time, top sources. Every chart shows the exact numbers next to each bar.

1.7 Social media signals

Some incidents come from monitored X accounts rather than from news outlets. They show the source as a handle (for example **@martinplaut**) and represent unverified field-level information — useful for early warning but always cross-check before acting. The **Origin** filter lets you separate news and social signals when needed.

1.8 Briefing

Click **+ Add to Brief** on an incident card to add it to a queue. Press **Generate Brief** to produce a clean, pre-formatted intelligence summary that you can copy and paste into an email or messaging tool.

2. Setting up your own copy of the dashboard

If you want your own private copy that you control and can update on your own schedule, you can copy ("fork") the repository into your personal GitHub account.

2.1 Create a free GitHub account

Skip this step if you already have one.

- 1 Go to <https://github.com> in your browser.
- 2 Click **Sign up** in the top right.
- 3 Follow the prompts: enter your email, choose a username and password, verify your email.

2.2 Fork the consultancy repository into your account

Forking means creating your own copy of a repository under your GitHub username. Your copy is independent.

- 1 Make sure you are logged in to your GitHub account.
- 2 Open the consultancy repository link in your browser: https://github.com/lizciat/security_dashboard.
- 3 In the top right of the page, click the **Fork** button.
- 4 On the next screen, leave the default options as they are and click the green **Create fork** button.
- 5 After a few seconds, GitHub will redirect you to your own copy at https://github.com/<your-username>/security_dashboard.

Bookmark this page — it is where you will go for everything else in this guide.

2.3 Enable the live web version (optional)

If you want your forked dashboard to be visible at a public URL like https://<your-username>.github.io/security_dashboard/:

- 1 On your forked repository, click the **Settings** tab near the top.
- 2 In the left sidebar, click **Pages**.
- 3 Under **Source**, click the dropdown and choose **GitHub Actions**.
- 4 Save. Your dashboard will be published automatically the next time the workflow runs.

3. Connecting your own Xquik account

The dashboard collects signals from X (Twitter) accounts using a service called **Xquik**. To run the dashboard from your forked repository, you need a Xquik account and an API key.

3.1 Create a Xquik account

- 1 Open <https://xquik.com> in your browser.
- 2 Click **Sign up** (or **Get started**) and follow the steps: email, password and any verification step.
- 3 Once you are logged in, you will see your Xquik dashboard.

3.2 Generate your Xquik API key

An API key is a long secret code that lets the dashboard fetch data on your behalf. Treat it like a password — do not share it publicly.

- 1 In your Xquik dashboard, look for a section called **API Keys**, **Developer**, or **Settings**.
- 2 Click **Create new key** (or similar wording).
- 3 Give the key a descriptive name like "Security Dashboard".
- 4 Click **Generate**. A long string starting with **xq_...** will appear on screen.
- 5 **Copy this key immediately** and paste it somewhere safe (a password manager is ideal). Xquik will not show you the full key again after you leave this page.

Tip

If you ever lose the key, you can come back and generate a new one. Just remember to update the GitHub secret afterwards (see Section 4).

4. Adding your Xquik key to your GitHub repository

The forked repository needs to know your Xquik key in order to fetch X data. GitHub provides a safe storage area for secrets like this so that the key never appears in the code or in any visible file.

4.1 Open the repository secrets page

- 1 Open your forked repository in the browser.
- 2 Click the **Settings** tab near the top.
- 3 In the left sidebar, scroll down to **Secrets and variables** and click on it to expand the menu.
- 4 Click **Actions** under that menu.

4.2 Add the key as a new secret

- 1 On the page that opens, click the green **New repository secret** button in the top right.

- 2** In the **Name** field, type exactly: **XQUIK_API_KEY** (uppercase letters and underscores — no spaces, no quotation marks).
- 3** In the **Secret** field, paste the full Xquik key you copied earlier. It should start with **xq_** and be one long line.
- 4** Click the green **Add secret** button.

The key is now safely stored. You will see it listed as **XQUIK_API_KEY** with no way to view its content again — this is normal and expected. If you ever need to change it, click on it and select **Update**.

5. Manually updating the dashboard with GitHub Actions

Your repository is configured to refresh the dashboard automatically once per day. You can also trigger a manual refresh at any time — for example, after a major incident or when you have just added your Xquik key.

5.1 Trigger a manual refresh

- 1 Open your forked repository in the browser.
- 2 Click the **Actions** tab near the top of the page.
- 3 The first time you visit this tab on your forked repository, you may see a yellow banner asking you to enable workflows. Click the green **I understand my workflows, go ahead and enable them** button.
- 4 In the left sidebar, click on the workflow called **Daily Update**.
- 5 Above the list of past runs, on the right side, click the **Run workflow** dropdown.
- 6 Leave the branch as **main** and click the green **Run workflow** button inside the dropdown.

A new run will appear at the top of the list within a few seconds. It shows a yellow spinning icon while it works. After three to five minutes, it should turn into a green check mark, meaning the dashboard has been updated.

5.2 What to do if the run fails

If the icon turns into a red cross instead of a green check mark, click on the failed run, click on the job named **build** to expand it, and look for the step highlighted in red. The most common issues are:

- **XQUIK_API_KEY not set** or auth errors — the secret was not added correctly. Re-check Section 4 (the name must be exactly **XQUIK_API_KEY**) and that you pasted the full key.
- **Quota exhausted** — your Xquik plan has reached its limit. Wait for the limit to reset, or upgrade your Xquik plan.

If you cannot resolve the issue yourself, contact the consultancy with a screenshot of the error.

5.3 View the updated dashboard

- **Live version** — if you enabled GitHub Pages (Section 2.3), refresh your dashboard URL: https://<your-username>.github.io/security_dashboard/.
- **Downloaded file** — open the **site** folder in your repository and click on **index.html** to view the latest version.

Quick checklist

Action	Where to go
View the latest dashboard	site/index.html in the repository, or your GitHub Pages URL
Create your own copy	Click Fork on the consultancy repository
Add your Xquik key	Settings → Secrets and variables → Actions → New repository secret
Refresh the data manually	Actions tab → Daily Update → Run workflow

If anything is unclear or the dashboard does not open as expected, please contact the consultancy team and we will assist you directly.